

New Ground: The First Promise

新的起点：第一次承诺

Theme: 大学生活与个人成长 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6, 127

English Story

Three weeks ago, Lin Wei still believed that a university ran on official notices. Recently he had begun to doubt it. Lately, every **evening**, a new complaint appeared in the group chat: a locked door, a missing sign, a laboratory that no map admitted. Plenty of people gave up. A **freshman** from a **provincial** town stood **beside** a broken printer on the **upper** floor of the library and asked a **stranger where** the lecture hall was. Autumn rain made every wrong turn worse. Lin promised Maya that **their** project would not depend on anyone **else**.

On Tuesday they wrote the promise on a whiteboard in a borrowed **club** room. **Their idea** was simple: **keep** one honest map of campus information and **change** it whenever reality changed. **Professor** Zhao, who held the **faculty chair** for first-year studies, read it twice. “**Your** map,” he said, “is a hypothesis. Good lord, **leadership** is not a **scholarship** or an **allowance**. A **senator** or a **statesman** may **sponsor** a report, but a map must answer to the student standing in the rain.” Maya **thought** the remark was **subjective**; Lin **thought** it was a test.

Their second meeting produced a **rate** they could defend. The survey had recorded age and **sex**, but not the need for a ramp. Of two hundred doors in the **preliminary** count, a measurable **proportion** opened only for people who knew the trick. A **doctorate**, a **bat**, a **lion** on a crest, or a pair of wet shoes made no difference to the lock. The **rear** entrance had its own **flow** of traffic, and nobody had ever recorded it. “**Personally**,” Maya said, “I do not believe in **anticipation**. I believe in a note, a number, and a witness.”

Lin began to doubt his own **originality**. A **creator** needs an **original thought**, not a **semicolon** in the right place. **Until** midnight he sat with the record, and nothing in it looked like **anything** a designer would admire. He raised his **hand** once to speak and put it down again. **Anyway**, the map was not art; it was a promise that had to survive a closed door.

On Friday the **club** agreed to help, because Maya had been supportive. **Their** support would reinforce the map and strengthen the case for a small budget. She used three photographs to illustrate the failure, and the group voted to conform to one rule: report only what a student sees. A rope across the unsafe path meant that nobody would automatically follow the crowd. Progress came steadily, and they began to believe they could achieve something real before the term review. **Their** work began to inspire first-year students; even Lin admitted a creative solution was worth it.

中文翻译

三周前，林伟还相信大学是靠官方通知运转的。最近他开始怀疑这一点。近来，每天傍晚群里都会出现新的抱怨：一扇锁住的门、一块缺失的指示牌、一间任何地图都不承认的实验室。很多人干脆放弃了。一名来自外省的新生站在图书馆上层一台坏掉的打印机旁，向陌生人打听报告厅在哪里。秋雨让每一次走错都更加难熬。林伟向陈曼雅承诺：他们的项目不会依赖任何人的许可。

周二，他们在一间借来的社团活动室里把承诺写在白板上。他们的想法很简单：维护一份诚实的校园信息地图，只要现实改变就跟着改。为一年级课程担任院系负责人的赵教授看了两遍。“你们的地图，”他说，“只是一个假设。天哪，领导力既不是奖学金也不是零用钱。参议员或政治家可以为一份报告做赞助人，但地图必须对站在雨里的学生负责。”曼雅觉得这番话太主观；林伟觉得这只是初步的考验。

第二次会议得出了一个他们能站得住脚的比例。问卷记录了年龄和性别，却没有记录对坡道的需求。在初步统计的两百扇门里，有相当比例只对已经知道诀窍的人打开。博士学位、球棒、纹章上的狮子，或者一双湿鞋，对那把锁毫无影响。后门有自己的人流，却从没有人记录过。“就我个人而言，”曼雅说，“我不相信预感。我相信一条记录、一个数字和一名证人。”

林伟开始怀疑自己的原创能力。创造者需要的是原创的想法，而不是一个位置正确的分号。他对着记录一直坐到午夜，里面没有任何东西像设计师会欣赏的作品。他有一次举手想发言，又放了下来。无论如何，这张地图不是艺术品，而是一个必须在关着的门面前存活下来的承诺。

周五，社团同意帮忙，因为曼雅从一开始就非常支持。他们的支持会加强这张地图，也会强化申请小额预算的理由。她用三张照片说明故障，大家投票一致同意遵守一条规则：只报告学生真正看得见的东西。危险小路上根绳子意味着不会有人再自动跟着人群走。此后进展稳定，他们开始相信自己能在学期评审之前做成一件真实的事。他们的工作开始鼓舞一年级学生，连林伟也承认，一个有创意的方案值得付出这些努力。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
their ðeə POS: pron	pron. 他们的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: pron. & a. The possessive case of the personal pronoun they;; as, their houses; their country.
your juə POS: pron	pron. 你的, 你们的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: pron. & a. The form of the possessive case of the personal; pronoun you.
where hweə POS: adv	adv. 在哪里; pron. 哪里; n. 地点 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: pron. & conj. Whether.; adv. At or in what place; hence, in what situation, position;; or circumstances; —...
keep ki:p POS: n	n. 生计, 维持, 保持; vt. 保持, 保存, 遵守, 看守, 整理, 维持, 履行, 经营, 拘留, 记帐; vi. 保持, 继续不断 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the main tower within the walls of a medieval castle or fortress; v. keep in a certain state, position, or...
hand hænd POS: n	n. 手, 爪, 指针, 掌握, 协助, 人手, 手艺, 手迹, 支配, 插手; vt. 交给, 支持, 搀扶 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the (prehensile) extremity of the superior limb; n. ability; n. a position given by its location to the side...
change tʃeɪndʒ POS: n	n. 变化, 找回的零钱, 找头, 更换; vt. 改变, 更换, 兑换 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an event that occurs when something passes from one state or phase to another; n. a relational difference b...
idea aɪ'diə POS: n	n. 主意, 办法, 理想, 思想, 概念, 意见; [医] 观念, 思想 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the content of cognition; the main thing you are thinking about; n. a personal view
until ən'tɪl POS: prep	prep. 直到, 在...以前; conj. 直到...时, 在...以前 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: prep. To; unto; towards; — used of material objects.; prep. To; up to; till; before; — used of time; as, he...
rate reɪt POS: n	n. 比率, 率, 速度, 价格, 费用, 等级; vt. 估价, 认为, 鉴定等级, 责骂; vi. 被评价, 责骂 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a magnitude or frequency relative to a time unit; n. amount of a charge or payment relative to some basis; n...
anything 'eniθɪŋ POS: pron	pron. 任何事 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. Any object, act, state, event, or fact whatever; thing of; any kind; something or other; aught; as, I wo...
else els POS: a	a. 别的, 其他的; adv. 另外, 否则, 不然 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. & pron. Other; one or something beside; as, Who else is; coming? What else shall I give? Do you expect a...
club klʌb POS: n	n. 俱乐部, 木棍, 球棒; vt. 用棍棒打, 缴纳; vi. 联合起来; a. 俱乐部的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a formal association of people with similar interests; n. stout stick that is larger at one end; n. a playin...
evening 'i:vnɪŋ POS: n	n. 傍晚, 晚间, 末期 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the latter part of the day (the period of decreasing daylight from late afternoon until nightfall); n. a la...
thought θɔ:t POS: n	n. 想法, 思想, 思维, 关心, 挂念; think的过去式和过去分词 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the organized beliefs of a period or group or individual
sex seks POS: n	n. 性别, 性欲; vt. 区别...的性别, 引起...的性欲 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. either of the two categories (male or female) into which most organisms are divided; n. all of the feelings...
professor prə'fesə POS: n	n. 教授 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. someone who is a member of the faculty at a college or university
anyway 'eniwei POS: adv	adv. 无论如何, 至少 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r used to indicate that a statement explains or supports a previous statement; anyhow, they're quiet"; anyway...
original ə'rɪdʒənəl POS: a	a. 最初的, 原始的, 有创意的; n. 原物, 原作 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. something that serves as a model or a basis for making copies; s. preceding all others in time or being as...
chair tʃeə POS: n	n. 椅子, 显要的席位, 主席; vt. 使入座, 使就任要职 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a seat for one person, with a support for the back; n. a particular seat in an orchestra; v. act or preside...
proportion prə'pɔ:ʃən POS: n	n. 比例, 比率, 均衡, 部分, 面积; vt. 使成比例, 使均衡 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the quotient obtained when the magnitude of a part is divided by the magnitude of the whole; n. magnitude o...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
leadership 'li:dəʃɪp POS: n	n. 领导能力, 领导阶层 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the activity of leading; n. the body of people who lead a group; n. the status of a leader; n. the ability to...
shoe ʃu: POS: n	n. 鞋, 靴, 外胎; vt. 给...穿鞋, 为马钉蹄铁 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. footwear shaped to fit the foot (below the ankle) with a flexible upper of leather or plastic and a sole a...
beside bi'saɪd POS: prep	prep. 在旁边 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. At the side of; on one side of.; n. Aside from; out of the regular course or order of; in a; state of dev...
upper 'ʌpə POS: a	a. 上面的, 较高的, 上级的, 上院的, 穿在外面的, 北部的, 地表的, 后期的; n. 鞋帮, 上齿 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. piece of leather or synthetic material that forms the part of a shoe or boot above the sole that encases t...
flow fləʊ POS: n	n. 流程, 流动, 流量, 洋溢, 泛滥, 涨潮; vi. 流动, 流泄, 畅流, 川流不息, 飘扬, 涌出; vt. 使流动, 淹没, 流出 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the motion characteristic of fluids (liquids or gases); n. the amount of fluid that flows in a given time; n...
faculty 'fækəlti POS: n	n. 才能, 能力, 全体教员, (大学的)系; [医] 能力, [大学]院系 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. one of the inherent cognitive or perceptual powers of the mind
allowance ə'laʊəns POS: n	n. 津贴, 零用钱, 限额, 折扣, 允许; vt. 定量供应 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an amount allowed or granted (as during a given period); n. a sum granted as reimbursement for expenses; n...
personally 'pɜːsənli POS: adv	adv. 亲自地, 个别地, 当面, 就本人而言, 针对个人地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. as yourself; r. as a person; r. in a personal way; r. in the flesh; without involving anyone else
stranger 'streɪndʒə POS: n	n. 陌生人, 门外汉; [法] 局外人, 非当事人, 第三者 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. anyone who does not belong in the environment in which they are found; n. an individual that one is not acq...
senator 'senətə POS: n	n. 参议员, (某些大学的)理事; [法] 参议员, 上议员 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a member of a senate
scholarship 'skɒləʃɪp POS: n	n. 学问, 学术成就, 奖学金 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. financial aid provided to a student on the basis of academic merit
lion 'laɪən POS: n	n. 狮子, 狮子(星)座, 国际狮子会会员 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. large gregarious predatory feline of Africa and India having a tawny coat with a shaggy mane in the male; n...
sponsor 'sponsə POS: n	n. 保证人, 赞助者, 发起者, 倡议者, 教父; vt. 发起, 赞助, 倡议 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. assume sponsorship of; v. assume responsibility for or leadership of
bat bæt POS: n	n. 蝙蝠, 球棒; v. 用球棒打, 眨眼; [计] 成批 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. nocturnal mouselike mammal with forelimbs modified to form membranous wings and anatomical adaptations for...
freshman phonetic unavailable POS: n	n. 新手, 生手, 大学一年级学生, (美)中学一年级学生 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a first-year undergraduate; s. used of a person in the first year of an experience (especially in United St...
preliminary pri'lɪmɪnəri POS: n	n. 初步做法, 初步措施, 预试, 预选赛; a. 初步的, 开始的, 预备的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a minor match preceding the main event; n. something that serves as a preceding event or introduces what fo...
rear rɪə POS: n	n. 后面, 背后, 后方; a. 后面的, 背面的, 后方的; vt. 养育, 培养, 饲养, 举起, 树立, 栽种; vi. 高耸, 暴跳 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the back of a military formation or procession; n. the side of an object that is opposite its front; n. the...
provincial prə'vɪnʃəl POS: n	n. 外地人, 粗野的人; a. 省的, 外地的, 偏狭的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (Roman Catholic Church) an official in charge of an ecclesiastical province acting under the superior gene...
creator kri:'eɪtə(r) POS: n	n. 上帝, 创造者, 创作者 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who grows or makes or invents things
subjective səb'dʒektɪv POS: a	a. 主观的, 个人的; [医] 主观的, 自觉的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. taking place within the mind and modified by individual bias
anticipation æn.tɪsɪ'peɪʃən POS: n	n. 预期, 预料; [医] 提前出现(如遗传病) Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an expectation; n. something expected (as on the basis of a norm); n. anticipating with confidence of fulfil...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
doctorate 'dɒktərɪt POS: n	n. 博士头衔 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n one of the highest earned academic degrees conferred by a university
statesman 'steɪtsmən POS: n	n. 政治家 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a man who is a respected leader in national or international affairs
originality ə.rɪdʒə'nælɪti POS: n	n. 创意, 新奇, 独创能力, 原始 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the ability to think and act independently; n. the quality of being new and original (not derived from some...)
semicolon 'semi.keʊlən POS: n	n. 分号; [计] 分号 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a punctuation mark ('; ') used to connect independent clauses; indicates a closer relation than does a per...